

HARDIK CHHABRA

putting quality before price." Today, HUFT has a presence in 15 cities with 75 stores across the country and a 1,100-member team. Its website boasts more than 5,000 pet products. Yet, the pet food section remains the star attraction, even though there is enough demand for their designer raincoats, shoes and beds too. Manufactured by HUFT themselves, the pet food platter is a pet dream come true—from goat milk pumpkin cookies to yak cheese dental chews and chicken nuggets.

Endorsement of HUFT's success comes not just from the consumers, but from the investors as well. Verlinvest and Sequoia Capital invested $37 million (Rs 300 crore approx.) in 2021, which HUFT has put to good use. "We have a 45,000 square feet facility in Bengaluru dedicated to innovating and researching on pet nutrition," says Dasgupta. "So all our supplements, food, edibles are researched and manufactured there."

HUFT's Chief Marketing Officer acknowledges that the demand for their pet food comes not just from the discerning palates of the pets, but equally from the cultural shift in pet parenting in culinary matters of their charges. "People have more exposure today and are interested in good quality nutrition for their pets," says Dasgupta. "Quality is the reason we have such high brand recall. If we stopped advertising today, we would still have brand value and customers."

"DOGS AND CATS HAVE BEEN SHOWN TO REDUCE LONELINESS AND COMBAT STRESS. THAT IS WHY MORE PEOPLE ADOPTED PETS DURING THE PANDEMIC"

SAMRIDDH DASGUPTA,
Chief Marketing Officer, HUFT

You want a happy dog or cat? Invest in their nutrition. This is the advice Gurugram-based dog and cat nutritionist Rashee Kuchroo has for pet owners. She recommends that pet food have these six basic nutri-